

Technical Writing Guide for the University of Arizona

JAZZIE TERRELL





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University of Arizona

Tucson, Arizona

Created in 2023 by Jazzie Terrell.



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Any references to historical events, real people, or real places are used fictitiously. Names, characters, and places are the product of the original source material and the author's imagination.

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Introduction

The *Technical Writing Guide for the University of Arizona* is a comprehensive scaffolded companion to ENGL 308: Technical Writing courses within the Writing Program at the university.

This guide provides insight into recommendation reports, remixing reports, self-assessment deliverables, and reflection. Prompted by an urgency for a framework for these components by learners in technical writing, the *Technical Writing Guide* provides support throughout major tasks in technical writing courses at the University of Arizona.

In asynchronous courses, an instructor is limited in the guidance to digital communication via a learning management system, email, and Zoom. As such, it's urgent to tailor content to specific courses or model tasks. This guide models material via textual descriptions and examples with the growing number of open educational resources build on course goals and objectives in ENGL 308: Technical Writing.

This text aims to clarify key aspects and attributes of technical communication related to collaboration, accommodation, design strategies, information, technology, ethics, inclusion, building connections, and writing.

In connecting learners' fields and professions with rhetorical lenses (audience/subject, context, author), technical writing courses at the University of Arizona intend to highlight collaborative work with composing, formatting, and designing technical documents for diverse audiences. For this reason, this text emphasizes communication with professionals in our fields to engagingly, accurately, and accessibly translate technical information from various perspectives.

We focus on communication skills in your chosen field, profession, or discipline and illustrate these skills for potential employers or graduate programs. With the completion of this text, it's encouraged that learners consider taking all three (3) professional and technical writing courses offered by the Writing Program at the University of Arizona: ENGL 307: Business Writing, ENGL 308: Technical Writing, with ENGL 313: Professional and Technical Writing. The Professional and Technical Writing Certificate is obtained after completion of all three (3) courses.

If there are any questions, comments, or concerns related to this work, contact Mx. Jazzie Terrell via email at jterrell@arizona.edu.

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Module 1

Recommendation Report



Preparing to Write the Recommendation Report

Your Field/Profession

How does your chosen field/profession:

- Communicate (Internally),
- Identify problems,
- Communicate Problems, and
- Solve Problems?

Identifying an Interviewee

Identify:

- What you already know about your selected profession's communication practices,
- What you want to learn or confirm,
- What you already know about identifying problems in that community, and
- What you need to learn.
- Who will help you answer your above questions and discuss



- Why might you select this person/people, and
- Will they be difficult to schedule? (either way, plan NOW!)

Constructing Interview Questions

- Identify a research question, and
- Create 5-8 potential interview questions specific to your research question and to your interviewee. These questions can be based on:

Behavior/experience questions that ask what you're trying to learn about your interviewee's experience,

Opinion/belief questions that ask what you're trying to learn about your interviewee's beliefs,

Knowledge questions that ask what you are trying to learn about what your interviewee knows,

Sensory questions ask what you're trying to learn about your interviewee's sensory details,

Background or demographic asks what you're trying to learn about your interviewee's background or demographic information,



- Along with justification and how each question will help you gather the information you'll need.

User Testing Others' Interview Questions

- Select an interview question set to test,
- Record responses to a 30-minute interview with someone's interview questions via transcripts or handwritten notes, and
- Discuss follow-up questions or new insights.

Creating a Scenario

- **Client**
 - Your specific/targeted audience, their expertise, attitudes towards the topic, what they already know, what they don't know, their responsibilities, and their power.

Audience Analysis

- Who are your readers?
- Describe the intended audience in terms of their:
 - The organization they work for and their position or title,
 - Occupation, profession, or field,
 - Needs for or interest in the information you plan to include in your work,



- Describe how your intended audience will use the information you include in your work,
- Describe the knowledge background of your intended audience and what they know and don't know about your topic.
- **Problem**
 - Describe the problem that needs to be solved, and the context that it exists in for at least 3-5 sentences.
- **Role/Persona**
 - Discuss who you are and how you're positioning and constructing yourself as you research and write.
- **Purpose**
 - Discusses what the client wants from you beyond the project itself.

Interviewing Your Interviewee

- Schedule a time with your interviewee(s) to set up dates, times, and locations. Consider note-taking and/or recording materials, permission, genre samples to utilize, and specific questions you'll ask.
- Conduct the interview in a polite and professional manner.
- Thank your interviewee.
- Transcribe the interview by revising and synthesizing your materials into a format readers can understand.



- Synthesize for trends by comparing and contrasting research, and themes, and by making connections to previous learning about your field/profession.
- Report with the [Interview Report Template](#)

Research Plan

Note the:

- Keywords and search terms,
- How the source will help you find/support a solution,
- The location of the search (i.e., Google Scholar, ERIC, Academic Search Premier, etc.),
- Date of publication
- Results of the source
- Value of the source

For six (6) to ten (10) sources.

Use the [Research Plan Template](#) as a guide, as needed.

Memos

The following is a memo template:

TO: [readers' names and job titles]

FROM: [your name and job title]

DATE: [complete and current date]

SUBJECT: [what the memo is about, highlighted in some way]

Mx. _____,

The opening of a memo includes the purpose, context, problem, and specific assignment or task. Overview the contents of the memo depending on your style, for example, direct and explicit. In addition, include the purpose to clarify why the audience should read the work. The opening should be 1 paragraph (5-7 sentences).

The context gives insight into your purpose and establishes the background of this purpose by explaining an event, circumstance, or problem background. According to Purdue OWL, it's often efficient

to explain the context completely in the opening of a sentence in a clear way that includes only what the reader needs:

“Through market research and analysis...”

Task segment that describes what you’re doing to solve the problem. Purdue OWL states that if the action was requested, then your task may be indicated by an opening sentence like:

“ You asked that I look at...”

If you want to explain your intentions, you might say:

“To determine the best method of promoting the new fall line, I will...”

Include only necessary information for decision-makers in a convincing manner that clarifies the planned situation and employ a purpose-statement forecast that divides subjects into the most important topics for the stakeholders.

Our memos in 308 are not to be longer than one (1) page. Thus, summary and discussion segments are unnecessary. However, do include a closing statement that states the action you wish the reader to take by considering the benefits to the reader from desired actions and how you could make those actions easier. For example:



“I will be glad to discuss this recommendation report with you during our Tuesday trip to the spa and follow through on any decisions you make”

Necessary attachments will include your findings or detailed information in the form of lists, graphs, tables, etc., at the end of your memo, with a notation about what is attached below your closing.

Attached: Focus Group Results, January - May 2022



Defining Recommendation Reports

Readings from [*Open Technical Communication*](#):

- [Chapter 2.9: Recommendation & Feasibility Reports](#),
- [Chapter 4.1: Report Design](#), and
- [Recommendation & Feasibility Report Samples](#).

Search for a recommendation report in your field and look at included sections, where the author spends their time, how they're citing research, what kind of evidence they include, similarities, differences, and how the audience and context impact the report.

Writing the Recommendation Report

Recommendation Report

This type of report starts from a stated need, a selection of choices, or both, and then recommends one, some, or none. For example, a company might be looking at grammar-checking software and want a recommendation on which product is the best. As the report writer on this project, you could study the market for this type of application and recommend one particular product, a couple of products (differing perhaps in their strengths and weaknesses), or none (maybe none of them are any good). The recommendation report answers, "Which option should we choose?" (or in some cases, "Which are the best options?") by recommending Product B, or maybe both Products B and C, or none of the products.

References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>



Transmittal Letter

The transmittal letter is a cover letter. It is usually attached to the outside of the report with a paper clip, but it can be bound within the report as a kind of author's preface. It is a communication from you—the report writer—to the recipient, who requested the report, and who may even be paying you for your expert consultation. Essentially, it says, "Okay, here's the report that we agreed I'd complete by such-and-such date. Briefly, it contains this and that, but does not cover this or that. Let me know if it meets your needs." The transmittal letter explains the context—the events that brought the report about. It contains information about the report that does not belong in the report.

Use the standard business letter format for cover letters. If you write an internal report, use the memorandum format instead; in either case, the contents and organization are the same:

- **First paragraph.** Cites the name of the report, putting it in italics. It also mentions the date of the agreement to writing the report.
- **Middle paragraph(s).** Focuses on the purpose of the report and gives a brief overview of the report's contents.



- **Final paragraph.** Encourages the reader to get in touch if there are questions, comments, or concerns. It closes with a gesture of goodwill, expressing hope that the reader finds the report satisfactory.

As with any other element in a report, you may have to modify the contents of this letter (or memo) for specific situations. For example, you might want to add a paragraph that lists questions you'd like readers to consider as they review the report.

If your report is over ten pages, bind it in some way and create a label for the cover.

The following is an example of a transmittal letter:



[Your Name]

[Street Address]

[City, State zip code]

[Full date]

[Full title of addressee]

[Organization name]

Dear [Addressee]:

I am submitting the attached recommendation report entitled [*Title Goes Here*].

This report is a recommendation report regarding the problem of [insert problem here] in the [field/profession]. The discourse community in this [field/profession] is [insert audience of the report] encounters [insert problem discourse community faces with communication]. This report details recommendations for this problem by [insert solution(s) to the problem here].

I would like to give special thanks to [interviewee]. In addition, [additional people you'd like to thank] for [reason for thanking].



I hope this report meets your needs, generates future studies, and educates [your intended audience] about [solution recommendations] for [insert benefit of using recommendations]. If you have any further questions, please feel free to contact me at x 563 or at your@email.address.

Warmly,

[Your Name], [Role]

[Organization]

End.: [Title of Recommendation Report]

Cover Page

Covers give reports a solid, professional look as well as protection. You can choose from many types of covers.

Labels

Be sure to devise a label for the cover of your report. It's a step that some report writers forget. Without a label, a report is anonymous; it gets ignored.

The best way to create a label is to use your word-processing software to design one on a standard page with a graphic box around the label information. Print it out, then go to a copy shop and have it photocopied directly onto the report cover.

There are no standard requirements for the label, although your company or organization should have its own requirements.

Common elements to include are:

- the report's formal title
- the intended recipient
- the authors (or, often, the author's organization)
- a report tracking number
- the date of submission



The following is an example of a cover page:



[Title of Recommendation Report]

Prepared for: [Name of Stakeholder(s)]

[Their Position]

[Organization]

Prepared by: [Your Name], [Your Role]

[Full Date]

[Organization Name]

[Organization Address]

[City, State, Zip Code]

References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>

Abstract

Most technical reports contain a descriptive abstract or an executive summary, and sometimes both. Each element summarizes a report's contents, but they do so in different ways and for different purposes.

Descriptive Abstract

This brief paragraph provides an overview of the report's purpose and contents. It's usually a single paragraph. In many report designs, the descriptive abstract appears at the bottom of the title page (not the cover page).

The following is an example of an abstract:



Abstract

This recommendation report examines recommendations] as solutions for [the problem of] for [the intended audience]. Reporting on [research question] highlights recommendations for [insert recommendations]. These recommendations are described, assessed, and presented. To conclude, [your reframed research question in light of recommendations] concludes the main discussion of the report.



References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>

Table of Contents

Any technical document of more than a few pages that include distinct major sections should include a table of contents (ToC), and each major section should start on a new page.

The ToC should not include the title page or the cover letter/memo. If the proposal includes an abstract and/or executive summary, those sections should appear in the ToC, and it is customary to paginate them with lower-case roman numerals. The ToC should not include itself. Treat it as page zero.

Always include at least the top two levels of headings, but how many subheading levels you include in a ToC is up to you. A long, complex report with multiple subheadings may need a ToC entry for each subheading, but this approach may result in an extremely long and confusing ToC. A potential solution is to create two ToCs, one listing just the top two levels of headings and one listing all levels of headings.

One final note: Make sure the words in the ToC are the same as in the text. As you write and revise, you might change some of the headings—don't forget to update the ToC accordingly.

The following is an example of a table of contents:



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Table of Figures

The table of figures (ToF), sometimes called the "list of figures," has many of the same design considerations as the table of contents. Readers use the ToF to find the illustrations, diagrams, tables, and charts in your report.

Please note that tables and figures are different things. Strictly speaking, figures are illustrations, drawings, photographs, graphs, and charts. Tables are rows and columns of words and numbers; they are not considered figures.

For longer reports that contain multiple figures and tables, create separate lists of figures and tables. Put them on a separate page from the ToC, but put them together on the same page if they fit. You can identify the lists separately, such as Table of Figures and Table of Tables.

References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>



Executive Summary

An executive summary is a more-detailed summary that includes all the important points in the proposal; it will contain multiple paragraphs and is significantly longer than an abstract, and its purpose is to allow a busy executive to decide whether reading the entire proposal is worthwhile.

Long proposals may contain both an abstract and an executive summary. Short proposals most likely contain an abstract but no executive summary.

There is no hard limit on an executive summary section's length; it can vary from a half-page to as long as needed. On a very long and complex proposal (for example, a proposal written for the federal government about a multi-billion dollar project), the executive summary can be a short book. However, a good rule of thumb is to limit an executive summary to two pages.

The executive summary is a hybrid of descriptive and informative summaries. Written for executives whose focus is business decisions and whose background is not necessarily technical, it focuses on conclusions and recommendations but provides little background, theory, results, or other details. It doesn't summarize research theory or method; it makes descriptive-summary statements: for example, "theory of heat gain, loss, and storage is also discussed."

To get a sense of the executive summary, study the following example:



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This recommendation report analyzes [problem with communication in your chosen field/profession's discourse community] and recommends [insert recommendations here]. The purpose of this recommendation report is to [insert research question].

First, [Synthesize introduction]. Next, [insert methods]. Finally, with the results of [insert results here], it is indicated that [insert feasibility of recommendations].

[Insert background to the problem for one (1) paragraph (5-7 sentences)].

It was found that [rephrase recommendations] are viable for [insert solution to the problem posed with your research question] for [insert chosen discourse community]. It is recommended that [insert recommendations] for [insert communication problem] within the [insert discourse community] in [insert field/profession].



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- Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>



Introduction

Every document must have an opening or an introduction.

Correspondence and routine **reports** need only an opening; more complex reports and other longer documents need an introduction.

An opening usually focuses the reader's attention on your topic and then proceeds to the body of your document. A formal introduction, however, sets the stage by providing the necessary information to understand the discussion that follows in the body. Introductions are required for documents such as **formal reports** and major **proposals**.

Routine Openings

When your **audience** is familiar with your topic or if what you are writing is brief or routine, then a simple opening will provide adequate **context**, as shown in the following examples:

Letter

Dear Mr. Ignatowski:

You will be happy to know that we have corrected the error in your bank balance. The new balance shows...



Memo

To date, 18 of the 20 specimens your department submitted for analysis have been examined. Our preliminary analysis indicates...

Email

Jane, as I promised in my e-mail yesterday, I've attached the engineering division budget estimates for the fiscal year 2023.

Opening Strategies

Opening strategies are aimed at focusing the readers' attention and motivating them to read the entire document.

Objective:

- In reporting on a project, you might open with a statement of the project's objective so that the readers have a basis for judging the results
- The preliminary goal of this project was to develop new techniques to solve the problem of waste disposal. Our first step was to investigate...



Problem Statement:

- One way to give readers the perspective of your report is to present a brief account of the problem that led to the study or project being reported.
- Several weeks ago, a manager noticed a recurring problem in the software developed by Datacom Systems. Specifically, error messages repeatedly appeared when, in fact, no specific trouble. . . . After an extensive investigation, we found that Datacom Systems . . .
- For proposals or formal reports, of course, problem statements may be more elaborate and a part of the full-scale introduction, which is discussed later in this entry.

Scope:

- This pamphlet provides a review of the requirements for obtaining a private pilot's license. It is not intended as a textbook to prepare you for the examination itself; rather, it outlines the steps you need to take and the costs involved.

Background:



- The background or history of a subject may be interesting and lend perspective and insight to a subject. Consider the following example from a newsletter describing the process of oil drilling:

From the bamboo poles the Chinese used when the pyramids were young to today's giant rigs drilling in hundreds of feet of water, there has been considerable progress in the search for oil. But whether in ancient China or a modern city, underwater or on a mountaintop, the objective of drilling has always been the same—to manufacture a hole in the ground, inch by inch.

Summary:

You can provide a summary opening by describing in abbreviated form the results, conclusions, or recommendations of your article or report. Be concise: Do not begin a summary by writing, "This report summarizes. . . ."

Change

This report summarizes the advantages offered by the photon as a means of examining the structural features of the atom.



To

As a means of examining the structure of the atom,
the photon offers several advantages.

Interesting Detail:

Often, an interesting detail will attract the readers' attention and arouse their curiosity. Readers of a white paper for a manufacturer of telescopes and scientific instruments, for example, may be persuaded to invest if they believe that the company is developing innovative, cutting-edge products.

The rings of Saturn have puzzled astronomers ever since they were discovered by Galileo in 1610 using the first telescope. Recently, even more rings have been discovered. . . . Our company's Scientific Instrument Division designs and manufactures research-quality, computer-controlled telescopes that promise to solve the puzzles of Saturn's rings by enabling scientists to use multicolor differential photometry to determine the rings' origins and compositions.

Definition:



- Although a definition can be useful as an opening, do not define something with which your audience is familiar or provide a definition that is obviously a contrived opening (such as “Webster defines technology as . . .”). A definition should be used as an opening only if it offers insight into what follows.

Risk:

- is often a loosely defined term. In this report, risk refers to a qualitative combination of the probability of an event and the severity of the consequences of that event. “In fact, . . .”

Anecdote:

- An anecdote can be used to attract and build interest in a subject that may otherwise be mundane; however, this strategy is best suited to longer documents and presentations.
- In his poem “The Calf Path” (1895), Sam Walter Foss tells of a wandering, wobbly calf trying to find its way home at night through the lonesome woods. It made a crooked path, which was taken up the next day by a lone dog. Then “a bellwether sheep pursued the trail over vale and steep,



drawing behind him the flock, too, as all good bellwethers do.” This forest path became a country lane that bent and turned and turned again. The lane became a village street, and at last the main street of a flourishing city. The poet ends by saying, “A hundred thousand men were led by a calf near three centuries dead.”

Many companies today follow a “calf path” because they react to events rather than planning. . . .

Quotation:

- Occasionally, you can use a quotation to stimulate interest in your subject. To be effective, however, the quotation must be pertinent — not some loosely related remark selected from a book of quotations.
- Deborah Andrews predicted that “technical communicators in the twenty-first century must reach audiences and collaborate across borders of culture, language, and technology” [B3]. One way we are accomplishing that goal is to make sure our training includes cross-cultural experiences that provide . . .

Forecast:



- Sometimes, you can use a forecast of a new development or trend to gain the audience's attention and interest.
- In the not-too-distant future, we may be able to use a handheld medical diagnostic device similar to those in science fiction to assess the complete physical condition of accident victims. This project and others are now being developed at The Seldi Group, Inc.

Persuasive Hook:

- While all opening strategies contain persuasive elements, the hook uses persuasion most overtly. A brochure touting the newest innovation in tax-preparation software might address readers as follows:
- Welcome to the newest way to do your taxes! TaxPro EZ ends the headache of last-minute tax preparation with its unique Web-Link feature.

Full-Scale Introductions

The purpose of a full-scale introduction is to give readers enough general information about the subject to enable them to understand the details in the body of the document. An introduction should accomplish any or all of the following:



- **State the subject.** Provide background information, such as definition, history, or theory, to provide context for your readers.
- **State the purpose.** Make your readers aware of why the document exists and whether the material provides a new perspective or clarifies an existing perspective.
- **State the scope.** Tell readers the amount of detail you plan to cover.
- **Preview the development of the subject.** Especially in a longer document, outline how you plan to develop the subject. Providing such information allows readers to anticipate how the subject will be presented and helps them evaluate your conclusions or recommendations

Consider writing an opening or introduction last. Many writers find that it is only when they have drafted the body of the document that they have a full enough perspective on the subject to introduce it adequately.

Manuals and Specifications

You may need to write one kind of introduction for reports, academic papers, or trade journal articles and a different kind for manuals or specifications. When writing an introduction for a manual or set of specifications, identify the topic and its primary purpose or function in the first sentence or two. Be specific, but do not go into elaborate detail. Your introduction sets the stage for the entire document, and



it should provide readers with a broad frame of reference and an understanding of the overall topic. Then the reader is ready for technical details in the body of the document.

How technical your introduction should depend on your readers: What are their technical backgrounds? What kind of information are they seeking in the manual or specification? The topic should be introduced with a specific audience in mind — a computer user, for example, has different interests in an application program and a different technical vocabulary than a programmer. Whether you need to provide explanations or definitions of terminology will depend on your intended audience. The following example is written for readers who understand such terms as “constructor” and “software modules.”

- The System Constructor is a program that can be used to create operating systems for a specific range of microcomputer systems. The constructor selects requested operating software modules from an existing file of software modules and combines those modules with a previously compiled application program to create a functional operating system designed for a specific hardware configuration. It selects the requested software modules, establishes the necessary linkage between the modules, and generates the control tables for the system according to parameters specified at run time.



You may encounter a dilemma common in technical writing:

Although you cannot explain topic A until you have explained topic B, you cannot explain topic B before explaining topic A. The solution is to explain both topics in broad, general terms in the introduction, as in the following paragraph that introduces “source units” and “destination units”:

- The NEAT/3 programming language, which treats all peripheral units as file storage units, allows your program to perform data input or output operations depending on the specific unit. Peripheral units from which your program can only input data are referred to as source units; those to which your program can only output data are referred to as destination units.

Then, when you need to write a detailed explanation of topic A (source units), you will be able to do so because your reader will know just enough about both topics A and B to be able to understand your detailed explanation.

The following is an example of an introduction to a recommendation report:



Introduction

To ascertain the optimal solution for [insert problem] as a means to [answer to your research question], [Organization Name] requested a research report to examine the discourse community of [field/profession] and their communication practices involving [problem], devise solutions, and present the findings and recommendations.

Currently, [Organization Name] struggles with [insert problem]. [Elaborate on the problem for 4-6 more sentences].

Therefore, [Organization Name] wanted determination of the best way to [insert solutions to problems] in the face of [insert problem]. Specifically, [Organization Name] asked for two (2) major tasks:

- Primary research consisted of analysis of audience analysis, construction of interview questions, targeted feedback from user testing for these questions, and asking the questions during an interview with [insert interviewee name here].
- Secondary research consisted of source selection with keywords/search terms, applicability towards finding a solution, location of the search, dates of publication, their results, and a valuation for [insert number of sources (6-10)] scholarly and popular sources.

Results indicate that [insert feasibility of solution] would aid in [insert benefits of implementing solution]. [Elaborate on the findings/results for 4-6 more sentences].

One significant finding regarding [the solutions] is [their answer to the research question] and [its benefits for the discourse community]. [Elaborate on findings]. To determine if [the solutions] are practical, [recommend further directions for this research].

We recommend, first, [insert recommendation]. [Elaborate on the recommendation's purpose and benefit for 2 sentences].

In the following sections, additional details about research methods, results, and feasibility of solutions are discussed, along with the recommendations.

References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>

Methods

The Methods section (also called Materials and Methods) allows the reader to see how the study was carried out (Fig. 3.1 and Fig. 3.2). This section can be enlightening because it connects the dots from the introduction (telling the reader what the problem is) and the results (showing data on “solutions” to the problem). There is more than one way to go about solving a problem. By explaining the approach used, the reader time is able to understand how the research progressed from step to step.

The results are a product of the methods used, so they should be carefully analyzed before beginning your testing. Questions to consider might be: Could it be done differently in a way that would be easier, more feasible, take less time, and yield “better” results? Did the method follow all the necessary steps? Did it use the scientific method? Was it ethical?



The methods section can also describe the technical theory involved in the study. If the research called for special equipment or software, it could be mentioned in the section.

Finally, stating the method and how the study was carried out allows others to repeat the study, thus lending credibility to your article by showing that the results can be reproduced using the methods described. Different branches of engineering have specific testing procedures that make studies easy to duplicate by listing which procedure and standard you used in your methodology. An example of these standards would be those set by the [American Society for Testing and Materials](#) (ASTM).

The following sample is of a methods section:

Research Methods

We began our research by interviewing [insert interviewee name], who emphasized [takeaway from interview]. “[Add a quote from the interviewee interviewee],” they said.

Early in our research, we discovered an article that validated that [interviewee] had discussed (Source Author, year). Our foci for the recommendation report research centered on [insert research question].

To construct recommendations for [insert problem] amongst the discourse community of [insert chosen discourse community], we broke the project down into two (2) tasks:

1. Primary research
2. Secondary research

Task 1. Primary research

[Include a synthesis for:

Constructing an audience analysis,

Constructing interview questions,

Receiving user testing on your interview questions, and



Conducting the interview.]

Task 2. Secondary research

[Include a synthesis for each source that includes:

The keywords and search terms used,

How each source helped you find and support a solution,

The location of the search,

Date of publication,

Results of the source, and

The value of the source

For a minimum of **ten (10) sources.**]

References:

Department of English, Linguistics, and Writing Studies at SLCC, [Technical Writing @ SLCC](https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/) (2020). Salt Lake Community College. <https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/>

Markel, Mike; and Selber, Stuart, [Technical Communication](https://store.macmillanlearning.com/us/product/Technical-Communication/p/1319245005) (2021). Bedford/St. Martin's. <https://store.macmillanlearning.com/us/product/Technical-Communication/p/1319245005>. 13.

Results

This section explains what you found, i.e., the answer to your research question. The Results and the Discussion (of the results) sections are the two most often mixed up sections by those who are new to this structure of writing. Just remember that Results are where you objectively summarize and present the data.

Generally, this section will begin with a brief overview of the results, then cover each of the main results from the data. Objectively point out the main ideas and use tables, figures, and other graphics as necessary to present the data. This section also discusses any limitations of the study. Fig. 2.6 shows an example of the Results section.

Writing Tips:

If you are writing a pure research paper you can present your findings using verbs of attribution: words that point out that these are someone else's ideas. For example, you could write:

- The author stated
- This article points out
- We found
- The results of the PCR analysis showed that

- Model results can be seen in Table X

Just remember not to interpret the information. For writing an experimental report, here are some tips:

Do:

- Report results and show supporting data
- Order results from most to least complex
- Describe results in the past tense
- Be concise: Examining patterns for 38,646 measurements of foliar $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ from non- N_2 -fixing species, the mean foliar $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ was 0.4‰ (Table 1).

Don't:

- Interpret results
- Repeat all the data from the table, instead select important results to report
- Be verbose: Table 1 indicates that after examining patterns for 38,646 measurements of foliar $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ from non- N_2 -fixing species, the mean foliar $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ was 0.4‰.

The following is an example of a results section:



Results

Research into [insert research question] and [insert problem statement] reveals insight into the implementation of [insert recommendations]. Primary interview research and secondary database and source gathering yielded [potential solutions to the problem].

It is recommended that [insert recommendations] be employed to solve the problem of [insert problem from your research question] in the [field/profession]. The discourse community of [insert chosen field/profession] benefitting from [insert benefits of implementing recommended solutions]. Overall, this recommendation report [summarize the answer to your research question].

5.2 Figures and Tables

The word figure is used to describe any graphic in the document that is not a table. It can refer to photographs, drawings, diagrams, maps, and other types of illustrations. Fig. 2.7 shows a table and Fig. 2.8 shows results with a figure.

Writing Tips:

Be consistent in formatting all figures and tables. Figure numbers and titles are listed in the caption below the figure. Table numbers and titles are listed above the table. Notes or source information is placed in the caption below the table. Figures and tables should be placed in the text where they are referred to, and the reference to the figure or table should be in the parenthetical text. Captions should be concise yet contain enough information for the reader to understand what the figure is about. Graphs should have clearly labeled legends.



Table number and description are above the table. Notes and sources for data are below the table.

Quaternary 2019, 2, 10 8 of 24

Table 2. Radiocarbon dates for giant rats and lizards on Tenerife. All calibrated ages were rounded to the nearest five years.

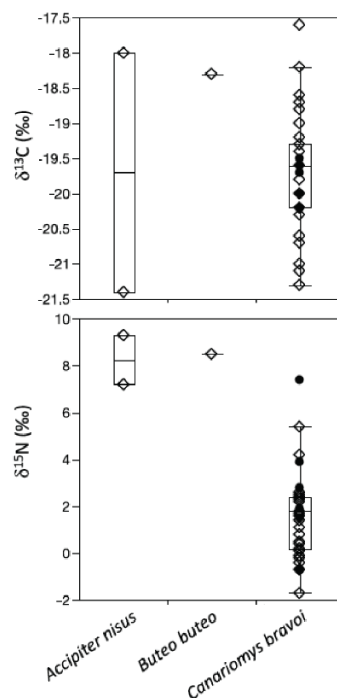
Taxon	Locality	Lab ID ¹	¹⁴ C years BP	2 σ Calibrated Date (Cal BP)	Mean $\pm$ 1 σ Calibrated Date (Cal BP)	Median Calibrated Date (Cal BP)	Source ²
<i>Canariomys bravos</i>	Cueva del Viento	CAMS 167035	13,980 $\pm$ 130	16,525–17,395	16,960 $\pm$ 435	16,965	1
	Cueva del Viento	UCI 184465	13,410 $\pm$ 70	15,885–16,355	16,120 $\pm$ 235	16,135	1
	Cueva del Viento	OxA-54502	12,230 $\pm$ 140	13,755–14,820	14,290 $\pm$ 535	14,200	2
	Cueva del Viento	CAMS 167036	9590 $\pm$ 70	10,720–11,170	10,945 $\pm$ 225	10,940	1
	Cueva del Viento	UCI 184466	8595 $\pm$ 35	9500–9630	9565 $\pm$ 65	9545	1
	Cueva del Viento	GrA 22661	5840 $\pm$ 50	6500–6750	6625 $\pm$ 125	6655	3
	Cueva del Viento	GrA 22658	4515 $\pm$ 45	5040–5315	5180 $\pm$ 140	5160	3
	Cueva del Viento	GrA 22680	2305 $\pm$ 40	2155–2380	2270 $\pm$ 113	2330	3
	Icod	GrA 22656	3010 $\pm$ 45	3065–3345	3205 $\pm$ 140	3200	3
	El Sobrado	GrA 22657	3720 $\pm$ 45	3960–4160	4060 $\pm$ 100	4065	3
	Arenas 3	KIA 40849	5400 $\pm$ 30	6180–6285	6235 $\pm$ 55	6230	4
	Arenas 1	KIA 40846	3605 $\pm$ 50	3825–4085	3955 $\pm$ 130	3915	4
	Arenas 3	KIA 47428	2315 $\pm$ 55	2155–2490	2325 $\pm$ 170	2335	4
	La Fortaleza	WK-28571	2304 $\pm$ 32	2180–2360	2270 $\pm$ 90	2335	4
	Bco. Moraditas	KIA-36264	2275 $\pm$ 25	2180–2350	2265 $\pm$ 85	2315	4
<i>Gallotia goliath</i>		Upper 95% CI				–1180	
		Upper 50% CI				1570	
	Golf Cave	CAMS 166991	5265 $\pm$ 35	5935–6180	6060 $\pm$ 130	6050	1
	Golf Cave	CAMS 166990	4975 $\pm$ 40	5605–5880	5745 $\pm$ 140	5700	1
	Arenas 3	KIA 47429	4895 $\pm$ 40	5585–5715	5650 $\pm$ 65	5630	4
		Upper 95% CI				4170	
		Upper 50% CI				5455	

¹ Radiocarbon lab codes: CAMS = Center for Accelerator Mass Spectrometry, Lawrence Livermore National Labs, U.S.A.; KIA = Kiel AMS, Germany; UCI = University of California, Irvine, USA; WK = University of Waikato, New Zealand. ² Sources for ¹⁴C data: 1 = This paper, 2 = Michaux et al. [108], 3 = Bocherens et al. [44], 4 = Rando et al. [23].

Fig. 2.7. Example of a Table. Source: Crowley et al. 2019. (CC: BY 4.0)

3.1. Icod Region

There were no differences in median $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ or $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ values among the 28 *C. brachy* individuals analyzed in this study and the six individuals previously analyzed by Bocherens and colleagues [44] from other sites in the Icod Region (Kruskal–Wallis $p > 0.05$; Table 1, Figure 2). Carbon isotope values were significantly more variable for individuals from this study (Bartlett $p = 0.026$; Table 1, Figure 2), while $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ values were significantly more variable for the three previously analyzed individuals from Cueva del Viento (Bartlett $p = 0.0048$; Table 1, Figure 2). We included all individuals in our analysis because there is nothing concerning about any of the data and they are biologically meaningful. Differences in variance among groups could reflect local variability in food resources, microhabitat, or temporal trends. The overall ranges in $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ and $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ values exhibited by *Canariomys* in the Icod region were -21.3 to -18.6‰ ($-19.8 \pm 0.7\text{‰}$) and -1.7 to 7.4‰ ($1.5 \pm 1.7\text{‰}$), respectively (Figure 2). Predatory birds had similar $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ values ($p > 0.05$) and significantly higher $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ values than *Canariomys* ($\chi^2 = 2.73$, $df = 2$, $p = 0.0204$; Table 1, Figure 2).



In the text a figure is referred to in parenthesis.

Figure number and description are part of the caption below the figure.

Figure 2. Boxplots comparing $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ and $\delta^{15}\text{N}$ values for taxa at Icod. Boxes represent 25 and 75% quartiles, and whiskers contain 1.5 times the interquartile range. Diamond symbols indicate the specimens analyzed in this study.

Fig. 2.8. A page in the Results section showing a figure with caption. Source: Crowley et al. 2019. ([CC: BY 4.0](https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/))



References:

Department of English, Linguistics, and Writing Studies at SLCC,
[Technical Writing @ SLCC](https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/) (2020). Salt Lake Community College.
<https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/>

Feasibility Conclusion

Feasibility Reports

When organizations consider a new project—developing a new product or service, expanding a customer base, purchasing equipment, or moving operations—they first try to determine the project's chances for success. A feasibility report presents evidence about the practicality of a proposed project based on specific criteria. It answers such questions as the following: Is new construction or development necessary? Are sufficient staff available? What are the costs? Is funding available? What are the legal ramifications? Based on the findings of this analysis, the report offers logical conclusions and recommendations on whether the project should be carried out. When feasibility reports stress specific steps that should be taken as a result of a problem or an issue, they are often referred to as *recommendation reports*.

In the condensed feasibility report shown in Figure F-1, a consultant conducts a study to determine how to upgrade a company's computer system and internet capability.



Introduction

The purpose of this report is to determine which of two proposed options would best enable Darnell Business Forms Corporation to upgrade its file servers and its Internet capacity to meet its increasing data and communication needs. . . .

Background. In October 2008, the Information Development Group put the MACRON System into operation. Since then, the volume of processing transactions has increased fivefold (from 1,000 to 5,000 updates per day). This increase has severely impaired system response time; in fact, average response time has increased from 10 seconds to 120 seconds. Further, our new Web-based client-services system has increased exponentially the demand for processing speed and access capacity.

Scope. We have investigated two alternative solutions to provide increased processing capacity: (1) purchase of an additional Aurora processor to supplement the one in operation, and (2) purchase of an Icardo 60 with expandable peripherals to replace the Aurora processor currently in operation. The two alternatives are evaluated here, according to both cost and expanded capacity for future operations.

Additional Aurora Processor

Purchasing a second Aurora processor would require increased annual maintenance costs, salary for a second computer specialist, increased energy costs, and a one-time construction cost for necessary remodeling and installing Internet connections.

Annual maintenance costs	\$35,000
Annual costs for computer specialist	75,000
Annual increased energy costs	7,500
Total annual operating costs	\$117,500
Construction cost (one-time)	50,000
Total first-year costs	\$167,500

The installation and operation of another Aurora processor are expected to produce savings in system reliability and readiness.

FIGURE F-1. Feasibility Report



System Reliability. An additional Aurora would reduce current downtime periods from four to two per week. Downtime recovery averages 30 minutes and affects 40 users. Assuming that 50 percent of users require system access at a given time, we determined that the following reliability savings would result:

$$2 \text{ downtimes} \times 0.5 \text{ hours} \times 40 \text{ users} \times 50\% \times \$50/\text{hour overtime} \\ \times 52 \text{ weeks} = \$52,000 \text{ annual savings.}$$

[The feasibility report would also discuss the second option — purchase of the Icardo 60 and its long-term savings.]

Conclusion

A comparison of costs for both systems indicates that the Icardo 60 would cost \$2,200 more in first-year costs.

	Aurora	Icardo 60
Net additional operating costs	\$56,300	\$84,000
One-time construction costs	50,000	24,500
First-year total	<u>\$106,300</u>	<u>\$108,500</u>

Installation of an additional Aurora processor would permit the present information-processing systems to operate relatively smoothly and efficiently. It would not, however, provide the expanded processing capacity that the Icardo 60 processor would for implementing new subsystems required to increase processing speed and Internet access.

Recommendation

The Icardo 60 processor should be purchased because of the long-term savings and because its additional capacity and flexibility will allow for greater expansion in the future.

FIGURE F–1. Feasibility Report (*continued*)

Before beginning to write a feasibility report, analyze the needs of the **audience** as well as the **context** and **purpose** of the project. Then write a purpose statement, such as “The purpose of this recommendation report is to determine the feasibility of expanding our Pacific Rim operations,” to guide you or a collaborative team.

For the purposes of our recommendation reports, we’ll be synthesizing a feasibility report into a conclusion that looks like the following example:



Feasibility Conclusion

[State the recommendation report's purpose and problem to address]. [Summarize the practicality of implementing your solutions].

[Discuss technical background, requirements, and criteria]

[Discuss and present details of each solution criteria and provide a comparative analysis and summary table of analysis].

[Provide conclusion and recommendations as next steps].



References

Mehler, Alexander; and Romary, Laurent, *[Handbook of Technical Communication](#)* (2012). De Gruyter Mouton.
<https://ils.unc.edu/callee/p507-lee.pdf>

Recommendations

This section states recommendations and directly addresses the problem outlined in the introduction. These may, at times, seem repetitive, but remember that some readers may skip right to the recommendation section. Also, there will be cases where there may be the best choice, but you wouldn't want to recommend it. Early in their history, laptop computers were heavy and unreliable—there may have been one model that was better than the rest, but even it was not worth having. You may want to recommend further research, a pilot project, or a re-design of one of the options suggested.

The recommendation section should outline what further work needs to be done, based solidly on the information presented previously in the report and responding directly to the needs outlined in the beginning. In some cases, you may need to recommend several ranked options based on different possibilities.

The following is an example of a recommendation section:

Recommendation

It is recommended that [Organization] pursue one (1) of two (2) options:

Option 1: [Insert actionable recommendation 1]

Although [drawback of proposed solution], it offers [benefits of proposed solution] in terms of [elaborate on benefits].

The problem of [insert problem here] regarding [insert research question] could be alleviated with the implementation of [rephrase solutions].

Option 2: [Insert actionable recommendation 2]

If [Organization Name] wishes to solve [insert problem] among [insert discourse community] in the [field/profession] of [insert field/profession], then [insert recommendation. This would be accomplished by [insert description of implementing the recommendation in a sentence]. In addition, [add to the description of going with the proposed solution]. This solution would [insert synthesis of the solution's benefits] regarding [insert answer to your research question].

[The organization] would [insert instructions to implement solution]. Also, [the organization] will [insert action to implement solution]. Next, [the organization] will [insert final action to implement solution]. Overall, [the solution to the problem and why it should be implemented].



References

Fleming, Will; Technical Writing at LBCC (2021). Open Oregon Educational Resources.

<https://openoregon.pressbooks.pub/lbcctechwriting/>

References and Appendices

Back Matter

Your instructions may include a list of references, a glossary or appendix, an index, or technical specifications. Items placed here are important to the overall instructions because they provide additional information that certain audiences may need but that are not critical to understanding how to complete the procedure

References

This type of report starts from a stated need, a selection of choices, or both, and then recommends one, some, or none. For example, a company might be looking at grammar-checking software and want a recommendation on which product is the best. As the report writer on this project, you could study the market for this type of application and recommend one particular product, a couple of products (differing perhaps in their strengths and weaknesses), or none (maybe none of them are any good). The recommendation report answers, "Which option should we choose?" (or in some cases, "Which are the best options?") by recommending Product B, or maybe both Products B and C, or none of the products.

Setting up the References List

A bit more challenging is setting up the list of information sources—that numbered, alphabetized list you put at the end of the document. (The context here is still the number system.) The best way to learn is to use examples. The following examples show you how to handle books, government reports, articles from magazines and journals, encyclopedia articles, and personal interviews.

Internet and Web Information Sources

For format information regarding citing Internet and web sources, see any of the resources listed above. As you will see, there are quite a few variations. However, a simple functional practice would use this order:

1. Author name, last name first. If unavailable, use the organization's name, followed by a period.
2. Next, the title of the page.
3. After that, the publication date of the web page, if available; otherwise, use the "N.d" indicator.
4. Next, the full URL of the page.
5. Finally, an indication of the date you accessed the page, for example, Accessed June 6, 2022.

Books



For books, first put the name of the author (last name first), followed by a period, followed by the title of the book in italics, followed by a period, followed by the city of the publisher, followed by a colon, followed by the publisher's name (but delete all those tacky "Inc.," "Co.," and "Ltd." things), followed by the year of publication, ending with a period. In this style, you don't indicate pages.

Burn, Duncan. *Nuclear Power and the Energy Crisis*. New York: New York University Press, 1978.

Magazine and journal articles

Start with the author's name first (last name first), followed by a period, then the title of the article in quotation marks and ending with a period, followed by the name of the magazine or journal in italics, followed by a period, followed by the date of issue of the magazine the article occurs in, followed by the beginning and ending page. If the article spread out across the magazine, you can write "33+." or "33(5)." The (5) in the preceding is an estimate of how many pages the article would be if it were continuous.

If there is no author, start with the article or book title. If there are two authors, add "and" and the second author's name, first



name first. If there are too many authors, use the first one (last name first), followed by "et al.," which means "and others."

Idso, S. B. "Recommendations for Pediatric Physician Communication." *Science* (March 28, 2023), 128-134.

Note

You may have seen complex entries indicating volume and issue numbers. While those may be required in some contexts, normally, you can simplify things and just include the issue date. But ask!

Encyclopedia Articles

Encyclopedia articles are easy! Start with the title of the article in quotation marks ending with a period, followed by the name of the encyclopedia (in italics if you have it; otherwise, underline), followed by the period, then the year of the edition of the encyclopedia.

"Nuclear Reactor." Van Nostrand's Scientific Encyclopedia. 2023 ed.

Reports

With reports, you're likely to deal with government reports or local informally produced reports. With most reports, you may



not have an individual author name; in such cases, you use the group name as the author. For government reports, the publisher is often the Government Printing Office, and the city of publication, Washington, D.C. Also, for government documents, you should include the document number, as is shown in the following example

Committee on Energy and Natural Resources, *U.S. Senate Hearings on the Effects of Carbon Dioxide Buildup in the Atmosphere*. DOA 2.8/NAA 6655.3. Washington: U.S. Government Printing Office, 2022.

Personal Interviews, Correspondence, and Other NonPrint Sources

With these sources, you treat the interviewee or the e-mail or letter writer as the author, follow that name with the person's title, followed by a period, then the company name, followed by a period, then the city and state, followed by a period, then what the information was ("Personal interview" or "Personal correspondence") followed by a period, ending with the date.

Smith, Eunice J., Public Relations Director. Fayette Power Facility. Fayetteville, TX. Personal interview. June 6, 2022.

Brochures



For these kinds of information sources, treat the company name as the author, followed by a period, use something identifying like the product name (including the specific model number), followed by anything that seems like the title of the brochure, followed by a period, ending with a date if you can find one (otherwise, put "N.d.").

Borrowed Graphics

It's certainly legal to copy graphics from other sources and use them in your own work—as long as you document them. You indicate the source of a borrowed graphic in the figure title (caption), located just below the graphic. In the figure title, you can show the source of the graphic in two ways—the long traditional way or the shorter way that uses the format of the number system:

A traditional source citation for a graphic: the complete bibliographic details are given, plus the page number:

Figure 1. Recommendations for Engineering Communication. The new system for efficiency. Source: Author, *Engineering Journal* (Tucson: Arizona, 2023), 32.

The following is an example of a references page:



References [(in alphabetical order)]

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)



Appendices

As you know, appendixes are for material that just doesn't seem to fit in the main part of a book but can't be left out of the book either. Appendixes are often the place for big unwieldy tables. Some technical publications have things like warranties in the appendixes. In terms of format, an appendix is just like a chapter—except that it is named "Appendix A" or some such, and the headers and footers match that different numbering and naming convention (A-1, A-2, and so on for pages in Appendix A).

The following is a sample appendix section:



Appendix: Interview

[Insert a 2-sentence summary of the interview and data about the interviewee].

Interview Questions

1. [Insert interview question]
2. [Insert interview question]
3. [Insert interview question]
4. [Insert interview question]
5. [Insert interview question]
6. [Insert interview question]
7. [Insert interview question]
8. [Insert interview question]



References

Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36.
<https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>



Recommendation Report

Rubric

Total: 31 points

The recommendation report includes the following sections:

- ☐ Transmittal Letter
- ☐ Cover Page
- ☐ Abstract
- ☐ Table of Contents
- ☐ Executive Summary
- ☐ Methods
- ☐ Results
- ☐ Feasibility Conclusion
- ☐ Recommendations
- ☐ References

The report also includes:

- ☐ Ten (10) sources,
- ☐ Six (6) sources cited in the text,
- ☐ Report formatting



- ☐ Rhetorically aware language and tone
- ☐ No more than 30 pages



Module 2

Recommendation Remix

Writing the Recommendation Remix

Recommendation Remix Planning

- Select a recommendation report that's different from your writing and field.
- Complete the audience analysis table
 - **Audience Analysis**
 - Who are your readers?
 - Describe the intended audience in terms of their:
 - The organization they work for and their position or title,
 - Occupation, profession, or field,
 - Needs for or interest in the information you plan to include in your work,
 - Describe how your intended audience will use the information you include in your work,
 - Describe the knowledge background of your intended audience and what they know and don't know about your topic.
- Post two (2) paragraphs (5-7 sentences each) describing how you:



- Might solve this scenario in your field (note: we're considering the differences rather than solving the problem),
- Might present the recommendation report to your field/profession, what modality (video, infographic, podcast) would be most effective, why, and how you'll change your approach to making a case for their solution,
- Compares and contrast the audience analysis table from your recommendation report.

Proposing the Remix

- Create a proposal that includes the following:
 - A title,
 - The audience and goal of your project/context,
 - Deliverable / the type of multi-media project you'll produce and why it's the best fit for the context,
 - Project technologies that cover:
 - Previous experience you have with multimodal production and what technologies you've used,
 - Technological application(s) you'll use for the project by discussing:
 - Previous experience, how you'll be learning something new,
 - Access to the where/how/why of the application
 - What you'll learn about this application, and providing where exactly you'll go for help with links,
 - A project plan/schedule that includes self-imposed goals, deadlines, and project components.



Getting Started on the Remix

- For **video**:
 - Read:
 - [*Open Technical Communication* Chapter 2: Oral Presentations](#),
 - [*Video Planning*](#),
 - [*Creating a Video Outline*](#),
 - [*Make a Video pt. 2 - Scripting*](#),
 - [*How to Make a Storyboard for Video*](#), and
 - [*The Non-Artist's Guide to Storyboarding Marketing Videos*](#)
 - Post:
 - A script,
 - A storyboard, and
- For **audio**:
 - Read:
 - [*Selecting a Podcast Format*](#),
 - [*Getting Started - A Podcast Guide for Students*](#),
 - [*Structuring a Podcast Script*](#),
 - [*How to Write a Podcast Script and Structure your Episodes*](#),
 - [*How to Write a Podcast Script*](#),
 - [*40 Best Educational Podcasts in 2022*](#), and
 - [*Thorough List*](#) compiled by Julie Christen
 - Post:
 - A conversational script for your podcast series with an introduction and [*royalty-free music*](#).
- For an **infographic**:
 - Read:
 - [*Handbook of Technical Communication*](#):
 - Layout and Design, and
 - Visuals.



- [Open Technical Communication:](#)
 - Chapter 9: Emphasizing Important Information,
 - Chapter 11: Designing Print and Online Graphics
 - Chapter 12: Creating Graphics
- Post:
 - A sketch of the layout and design of your infographic, and
 - A description of your design for your infographic.

Write a reflection on what excites you about the project, how you might use what you learn, and what you're most concerned about.

Respond to two (2) peers discussing what you liked and why, along with one (1) suggestion for each.

Drafting and Reviewing the Recommendation Remix

The recommendation remix will help you understand and explain information to an audience in different contexts, which is at the heart of technical communication. For the recommendation remix, you'll present a classmate's recommendation report that they collected and present to a different audience via video, audio, or infographic.

Adapting the recommendations from one team member in a different department's recommendation report to solve an organizational problem will allow you to **present the recommendations to members of your field/discipline in a new context.**



Studying the original recommendation report will dictate the relevant information to your context and audience. Then, you will design and produce a deliverable that presents the problem and recommendation to your new audience from the recommendation report of your classmate.

You'll select one (1) of the following deliverables for the remix:

- **Video** (or video series),
 - Produce a 5-7 minute video (or series of shorter videos that equal 5-7 minutes) with visuals.
- **Audio** (podcast),
 - 2-4 podcast series 10-15 minutes long,
- **Static image** (infographic, website),
 - Produce an infographic with visuals,



Recommendation Remix

Rubric

The Overall Project:

- ☐ Presents a manageable amount of information,
- ☐ Discusses:
 - ☐ The problem
 - ☐ The recommendation, and
 - ☐ Evidence for the recommendation
- ☐ Is catered for your particular audience and modality,
- ☐ Citations are formatted as hyperlinked footnotes,
- ☐ Includes a separate reference page, and
- ☐ The reference page is in APA7 style.

Video

- ☐ 5-7 minutes, total,
- ☐ Uses images that serve a purpose,
- ☐ Is consistent in layout, font, etc., across the entire project,
- ☐ Employs a conversational and engaged tone,
- ☐ Includes reasonably speeded speech,
- ☐ Includes **captions**,
- ☐ Incorporates visuals and speech to tell the story, and
- ☐ Provides citations for evidence and examples that are used.

Audio

- ☐ 10-15 minutes, total,



- ☐ Is delivered as a series of 2-3,
- ☐ The tone is conversational and engaging,
- ☐ Speech is at a reasonable speed,
- ☐ Music is included that doesn't overpower the voice,
- ☐ Includes an introduction that's to be re-used for each episode.
- ☐ Includes a transcript, and
- ☐ Provides citations for evidence and examples that are used (on the transcript).

Static Image

- ☐ Is legal (11x17) size or uses the standard template size in the program selected,
- ☐ Uses images that serve a purpose,
- ☐ Uses a consistent layout and white space to promote readability and prevent clutter,
- ☐ Is consistent in layout, design, font, etc., across the entire project,
- ☐ Considers color and font for design and accessibility purposes,
- ☐ Chunks to facilitate learning by using headings, subheadings, visual cues, lines, arrows, colors, etc., and
- ☐ Provides citations for evidence and examples that are used.

At the top of your draft, compose two (2) focus questions for your peers to focus on in their responses.



Module 2.5

Final Self-Reflection

Writing the Final Self-Reflection

Synthesize Learning

- Mind Map:
 - Construct a [mind/cluster map](#) by drawing, using post-its, or an app like: [MS Word Smart Art](#), [MindMeister](#), [Mindomo](#), [LovelyCharts](#), [Maptini](#), [Popplet](#), [Gliffy](#), [Cacoo](#), [Webspiration](#), [SpicyNodes](#), [Coggle](#), or [LucidChart](#) by:
 - Writing your name and ENGL 308 in the middle of the page and circling it,
 - Branching off the main circle and creating additional circles of information with smaller topics representing each of the “habits of mind” from the Framework for Success in [Postsecondary Writing](#),
 - Curiosity, openness, engagement, creativity, persistence, responsibility, flexibility, and metacognition.
 - Make even smaller circles with evidence from your coursework that you’ll connect to each habit of mind with specific activities, drafts, sections of final projects, readings, etc.,



- Draw lines connecting circles together—doodling is allowed to generate ideas.
- Freewrite:
 - Review your previous reflections and spend 20 minutes writing about what you see in those reflections,
 - Connect your goals, course goals, growth as a writer, and further growth after ENGL 308 and/or outside of school,
 - Note artifacts that highlight the particular learning goals you're connecting to, and
 - Discuss the future application of what you learned.

Upload a picture or [screenshot](#) of your activity along with **a single sentence that summarizes your learning in ENGL 308: Technical Writing.**

Identify and Assign Learning Artifacts (Evidence)

Describe each Student Learning Outcome (SLO) in your own words and connect each with a relevant course artifact:

- *Write, edit, and design with and for readers, users, and stakeholders in professional contexts with a focus on accessibility (collaboration & accommodation),*
- *Implement flexible strategies for designing and redesigning communication in professional contexts with a focus on document design (design strategies),*



- *Analyze and manage information and technologies in ways that are responsive to specific readers or users in professional/technical contexts (information and technology),*
- *Reflect on growth as a professional/technical communicator in professional/technical contexts (growth process),*
- *Write, edit, and design ethically and inclusively for people and situations in professional/technical contexts (ethics & inclusion)*

Final Reflective Self-Assessment

The Final Self-Reflection consists of a deliverable and a two (2) page self-assessment.

For our Final Reflective Self-Assessment, we'll:

- Rhetorically assess your work in technical writing and how it'll help your future endeavors by describing what you learned during the course and how you think what you learned transfers to other courses, professional contexts, and personal contexts with evidence (artifacts) from the work you've done in 308 to support what you learned and how it transfers for **two (2) pages**.
- This will help us reflect and collect evidence for the transfer of learning to other future endeavors beyond technical writing and describe how your work might prove useful in the future.

Final Reflective Self-Assessment Deliverable

For our Final Self-Assessment Deliverable, we'll:

- Compose a letter that hyperlinks artifacts in your *shared* Google Drive folder,
- Create a 5-7 minute captioned video where you screen share referenced artifacts with technology of your choice,
- Create a website, slideshow, Jamboard, infographic, or other static image text with screenshots, links, or other ways to show what you're discussing,
- Suggest your own!
- Note organization, grammar, structure, and punctuation.



Final Self-Reflection Rubric

The Final Self-Reflection:

- ☐ Is two (2) pages, 5-7 minutes, a static image series with at least five (5) images with explanations, and
- ☐ Is rhetorically aware of organization, grammar, structure, and punctuation.

The Self-Reflection Deliverable:

- ☐ Discusses what you learned throughout ENGL 308: Technical Writing,
- ☐ Describes how you think what you learned transfers to other courses, professional contexts, and personal contexts, and
- ☐ Provides evidence (artifacts) from your work in the course to support what you think you learned and how it transfers.



References

- Department of English, Linguistics, and Writing Studies at SLCC, [Technical Writing @ SLCC](https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/) (2020). Salt Lake Community College. <https://slcc.pressbooks.pub/technicalwritingatslcc/>
- Fleming, Will; Technical Writing at LBCC (2021). Open Oregon Educational Resources. <https://openoregon.pressbooks.pub/lbccctechwriting/>
- Hamlin, Annemarie; Rubio, Chris; and DeSilva, Michele, [Technical Writing](https://openoregon.pressbooks.pub/technicalwriting/) (2017). Open Oregon Educational Resources. <https://openoregon.pressbooks.pub/technicalwriting/>
- Markel, Mike; and Selber, Stuart, [Technical Communication](https://store.macmillanlearning.com/us/product/Technical-Communication/p/1319245005) (2021). Bedford/St. Martin's. <https://store.macmillanlearning.com/us/product/Technical-Communication/p/1319245005>. 13.
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- Reardon, Tiffani; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36. <https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>



Appendices



Memo Template

TO: [readers' names and job titles]

FROM: [your name and job title]

DATE: [complete and current date]

SUBJECT: [what the memo is about, highlighted in some way]

Mx. _____,

The opening of a memo includes the purpose, context, problem, and specific assignment or task. Overview the contents of the memo depending on your style, for example, direct and explicit. In addition, include the purpose to clarify why the audience should read the work. The opening should be 1 paragraph (5-7 sentences).

The context gives insight into your purpose and establishes the background of this purpose by explaining an event, circumstance, or problem background. According to Purdue OWL, it's often efficient to explain the context completely in the opening of a sentence in a clear way that includes only what the reader needs:

“Through market research and analysis...”

Task segment that describes what you’re doing to solve the problem. Purdue OWL states that if the action was requested, then your task may be indicated by an opening sentence like:

“ You asked that I look at...”

If you want to explain your intentions, you might say:

“To determine the best method of promoting the new fall line, I will...”

Include only necessary information for decision-makers in a convincing manner that clarifies the planned situation and employ a purpose-statement forecast that divides subjects into the most important topics for the stakeholders.

Our memos in 308 are not to be longer than one (1) page. Thus, summary and discussion segments are unnecessary. However, do include a closing statement that states the action you wish the reader to take by considering the benefits to the reader from desired actions and how you could make those actions easier. For example:



“I will be glad to discuss this recommendation report with you during our Tuesday trip to the spa and follow through on any decisions you make”

Necessary attachments will include your findings or detailed information in the form of lists, graphs, tables, etc., at the end of your memo, with a notation about what is attached below your closing.

Attached: Focus Group Results, January - May 2022



Providing Feedback

- Read:
 - [Guidelines for Students - Peer Review](#),
 - [Feedback and Improvement Paragraphs 1 & 2](#), and
 - [Describe, Evaluate, and Suggest](#).
- Compose:
 - A letter of 2-3 paragraphs discussing the project's adherence to the rubric, its audience appeals, and the focus areas/questions your peer has.



Progressive Reflections

Five (5) times this semester, we'll reflect on:

- A topic from the course,
- How you're doing,

Questions you have about the course content (or state that you have no questions)



Sample Group

Recommendation Reports

There are samples of recommendation report components throughout this guide, and, in addition, here, two (2) group sample recommendation reports are presented:

[Recommendation Report Sample 1](#)

[Recommendation Report Sample 2](#)

Though we're not incorporating 100% of the content that these authors had, these samples should prove useful in showing examples of

- Front Matter
 - Cover/transmittal letters,
 - Abstracts that synthesize research,
 - Executive summaries,
 - Tables of contents,
- Main Body
 - Introductions,



- Methods used to produce the report that provides details of where and how information was learned, along with how information was analyzed and synthesized,
 - Results that suggest strategies and recommendations based on research,
- Back Matter
 - References, and
 - Appendices.



Recommendation Report

Template

[Your Name]

[Street Address]

[City, State zip code]

[Full date]

[Full title of addressee]

[Organization name]

Dear [Addressee]:

I am submitting the attached recommendation report entitled [*Title Goes Here*].

This report is a recommendation report regarding the problem of [insert problem here] in the [field/profession]. The discourse community in this [field/profession] is [insert audience of the report] encounters [insert problem discourse community faces with communication]. This report details recommendations for this problem by [insert solution(s) to the problem here].

I would like to give special thanks to [interviewee]. In addition, [additional people you'd like to thank] for [reason for thanking].

I hope this report meets your needs, generates future studies, and educates [your intended audience] about [solution recommendations] for [insert benefit of using recommendations]. If you have any further questions, please feel free to contact me at x 563 or at your@email.address.

Warmly,

[Your Name], [Role]

[Organization]

End.: [Title of Recommendation Report]



[Title of Recommendation Report]

Prepared for: [Name of stakeholder(s)]

[Their position]

[Organization]

Prepared by: [Your name], [Your Role]

[Full Date]

[Organization Name]

[Organization Address]

[City, State, Zip Code]

Abstract

This recommendation report examines recommendations] as solutions for [the problem of] for [the intended audience]. Reporting on [research question] highlights recommendations for [insert recommendations]. These recommendations are described, assessed, and presented. To conclude, [your reframed research question in light of recommendations] concludes the main discussion of the report.



Table of Contents [(for a single-spaced report)]

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2.0 Methods	7
3.0 Results	9
4.0 Feasibility Conclusion	10
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References and Appendices	12



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This recommendation report analyzes [problem with communication in your chosen field/profession's discourse community] and recommends [insert recommendations here]. The purpose of this recommendation report is to [insert research question].

First, [Synthesize introduction]. Next, [insert methods]. Finally, with the results of [insert results here], it is indicated that [insert feasibility of recommendations].

[Insert background to the problem for one (1) paragraph (5-7 sentences)].

It was found that [rephrase recommendations] are viable for [insert solution to the problem posed with your research question] for [insert chosen discourse community]. It is recommended that [insert



recommendations] for [insert communication problem] within the
[insert discourse community] in [insert field/profession].

Research Methods

We began our research by interviewing [insert interviewee name], who emphasized [takeaway from interview]. “[Add a quote from the interviewee interviewee],” they said.

Early in our research, we discovered an article that validated that [interviewee] had discussed (Source Author, year). Our foci for the recommendation report research centered on [insert research question].

To construct recommendations for [insert problem] amongst the discourse community of [insert chosen discourse community], we broke the project down into two (2) tasks:

1. Primary research
2. Secondary research

Task 1. Primary research

[Include a synthesis for:



Constructing an audience analysis,

Constructing interview questions,

Receiving user testing on your interview questions, and

Conducting the interview].

Task 2. Secondary research

[Include a synthesis for each source that includes:

The keywords and search terms used,

How each source helped you find and support a solution,

The location of the search,

Date of publication,

Results of the source, and

The value of the source



For a minimum of **ten (10) sources**].



Feasibility Conclusion

[State the recommendation report's purpose and problem to address]. [Summarize the practicality of implementing your solutions].

[Discuss technical background, requirements, and criteria]

[Discuss and present details of each solution criteria and provide a comparative analysis and summary table of analysis].

[Provide conclusion and recommendations as next steps].

Results

Research into [insert research question] and [insert problem statement] reveals insight into the implementation of [insert recommendations]. Primary interview research and secondary database and source gathering yielded [potential solutions to the problem].

It is recommended that [insert recommendations] be employed to solve the problem of [insert problem from your research question] in the [field/profession]. The discourse community of [insert chosen field/profession] benefitting from [insert benefits of implementing recommended solutions]. Overall, this recommendation report [summarize the answer to your research question].

Recommendations

It is recommended that [Organization] pursue one (1) of two (2) options:

Option 1: [Insert actionable recommendation 1]

Although [drawback of proposed solution], it offers [benefits of proposed solution] in terms of [elaborate on benefits].

The problem of [insert problem here] regarding [insert research question] could be alleviated with the implementation of [rephrase solutions].

Option 2: [Insert actionable recommendation 2]

If [Organization Name] wishes to solve [insert problem] among [insert discourse community] in the [field/profession] of [insert field/profession], then [insert recommendation. This would be accomplished by [insert description of implementing the recommendation in a sentence]. In addition, [add to the

description of going with the proposed solution]. This solution would [insert synthesis of the solution's benefits] regarding [insert answer to your research question].

[The organization] would [insert instructions to implement solution]. Also, [the organization] will [insert action to implement solution]. Next, [the organization] will [insert final action to implement solution]. Overall, [the solution to the problem and why it should be implemented].



References [(in alphabetical order)]

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)

Author1 Last Name, First Name; Author2 Last Name, First Name; Author3 Last Name, and First Name, [Hyperlink of Source Title](#) (year of publication).
Location. [Link](#)



Appendix: Interview

[Insert a 2-sentence summary of the interview and data about the interviewee].

Interview Questions

1. [Insert interview question]
2. [Insert interview question]
3. [Insert interview question]
4. [Insert interview question]
5. [Insert interview question]
6. [Insert interview question]
7. [Insert interview question]
8. [Insert interview question]



ENGL 308 Syllabus

Spring 2023

Asynchronous Online

Mx. Jazzie Terrell (jterrell1@arizona.edu)

Office hours via Zoom, scheduling via [Calendly](#)

Land Acknowledgement

We respectfully acknowledge the University of Arizona is on the land and territories of Indigenous peoples. Today, Arizona is home to 22 federally recognized tribes, with Tucson being home to the O'odham and the Yaqui. Committed to diversity and inclusion, the University strives to build sustainable relationships with sovereign Native Nations and Indigenous communities through education offerings, partnerships, and community service.



Course Description

Greetings, everyone, and welcome to our guide for **ENGL 308: Technical Writing**. This guide exists to clarify concepts relating to recommendation reports, multimodal projects, and self-reflection.

The goal of this course is to explore STEM fields/business conventions via a rhetorical lens through individual and collaborative work emphasizing composing, formatting, and designing technical documents for diverse audiences. Further, by communicating with professionals in our fields, we learn to translate technical information from various perspectives (e.g., subject experts, non-specialists, and users with special needs) in ways that are engaging, accurate, and accessible.

Professional and Technical Writing Certificate

This course counts toward the undergraduate Professional & Technical Writing Certificate, which complements your work in any major and showcases communication skills that are widely appealing to employers and graduate programs. The certificate includes three courses (including this one) and one portfolio you will complete after taking the courses. You can take the courses (ENGL 307, 308, and 313) face-to-face or online. Learn more and get started on the certificate at



<https://english.arizona.edu/professional-technical-writing-certificate>.

Course Goals and Objectives

ENGL 308 Technical Writing is designed to hone students' abilities to:

- *Write, edit, and design for readers, users, and stakeholders with a focus on user research in technical contexts (collaboration & accommodation),*
- *Implement flexible strategies for designing and redesigning communication in technical contexts (design strategies)*
- *Analyze and manage information and technologies in ways that are responsive to specific readers or users in technical contexts (Information & technology),*
- *Reflect on growth as a professional/technical communicator in technical contexts (ethics & inclusion),*
- *Utilize multiple perspectives and make meaningful connections and problem-solving across disciplines and social positions while thinking conceptually and critically (General Education: Building Connections), and*
- *Demonstrate rhetorical awareness and writing proficiency for a variety of contexts and execute disciplinary genre conventions of organization, design, style, mechanics, and citation format while reflecting on writing development (General Education: Writing Attribute).*



Required Text

Reardon, Tiffany; Powell, Tamara; Arnett, Jonathan; Logan, Monique; and Race, Cassandra, [Open Technical Communication](#) (2019). Faculty Bookshelf. 36. <https://digitalcommons.kennesaw.edu/facbooks/36>

Assessment

All writers in this course conduct research, analyze issues and texts (including multimedia texts), and provide feedback on one another's work via peer review. As such, there are major projects that include both long and short tasks.

Project 1: Recommendation Report (30% of course grade)

Recommend options to solve a problem or fill a need in your chosen field/profession.

Project 2: Recommendation Remix (20% of course grade)

Remix a classmate's recommendation report to fit your chosen field/profession's audience in either video, a podcast, or an infographic.

Project 2.5: Final Self-Reflection (7 points)



Self-assessment reflection and deliverable that assesses work done in ENGL 308 and how it'll help you in future endeavors.

Short Tasks / Homework

(30% of course grade)

See course schedule

Reflections (includes final self-reflection) (20% of course grade)

See course schedule

Grading Policies

- You must keep electronic copies of all your tasks to re-submit or to use in a grade appeal.
- Late work is submitted as long as Mx. Jazzie Terrell is notified via email: jterrell1@arizona.edu.

Final Grades

Grades are determined according to the following scale:

A (90-100%)

B (80-89.9%)



C (70-79.9%)

D (60-69.9%)

E (59% or below)

Final grades are calculated based on the weights listed in the above table. In order to receive a passing grade in the course (D or higher), students must submit all final versions of all major course projects.

More Information on Grades

[Grade Policies](#)

[Incomplete Grades](#)

[Withdrawals](#)

[Grade Replacement Options](#)

Submitting your Work

- You are responsible for submitting your work by the published assignment deadline.
- You are responsible for submitting your work in the manner specified in the assignment description.



- Late Work: All work (major projects, homework, classwork, minor projects, etc.) that is turned in late may be accepted and earn up to full credit at Mx. Jazzie Terrell's discretion.
- Final grades are posted 48 hours after the final project is due, and no late work will be accepted after grades are posted.
- Questions, comments, or concerns should be directed to Mx. Jazzie Terrell via email: jterrell1@arizona.edu

Student Support

[Writing Center at the Think Tank](#)

Free resource for UArizona undergraduate and graduate students as well as faculty and staff. Work individually with a trained peer tutor at any point during the writing process, from brainstorming to revising and editing. Appointments required.

[Writing Skills Improvement Program \(WSIP\)](#)

Both free and fee-based resources for UArizona students. Services include 30 or 50-minute tutoring sessions with WSIP staff, with additional tutoring available via payment; three series of free Weekly Writing Workshops with no prior registration necessary.



[Veterans Education and Transition Services](#)

Provides support for student veterans in terms of academics, institutional access, student involvement, and research.

[Advising Resource Center: Academic Advising](#)

Questions about your academic progress this semester, your curricular plans for the future, etc.

Additional Resources

[Disability Resource Center](#)

[Dean of Students Office](#)

[Campus Health](#)

[Counseling and Psychological Services \(CAPS\)](#)

Course Policies

Attendance and Participation

Asynchronous

For asynchronous classes, we DO NOT keep track of “attendance.”
Work submission is attendance.

Participation Policy

In an online class, participation counts as attendance, and a student does not count as having participated in a course if they have only logged into the course D2L site. The following definitions of attendance and absence apply unless a student makes alternative arrangements with the instructor:

Attendance: participating in the class by submitting at least one assignment by the required deadlines; an assignment may include submitting or posting an assignment.

Absence: not submitting any work for required deadlines (each passing deadline without submitted work is an absence).

Students who have not completed any work by the end of the second deadline have accumulated two absences and may be subject to administrative withdrawal. Students must continue to submit work to be counted as participating and present regularly.

Not being able to submit an assignment on time due to scheduling conflicts or internet connectivity issues does not excuse you from completing the assignment.

Non-attendance for any reason does not guarantee an automatic extension of the due date or rescheduling of examinations/assessments.

Please communicate and coordinate any request directly with me and notify me if you will be missing an assignment deadline.

Absences for any sincerely held religious belief, observance, or practice will be accommodated where reasonable.

If you must miss more than 2 deadlines of class, you should contact the Dean of Students Office DOS-deanofstudents@email.arizona.edu to share documentation about the challenges you are facing.

UA Policies about Attendance & Participation

Dean of Students attendance policy:

<https://deanofstudents.arizona.edu/policies/attendance-policies-and-practices>

UA's policy concerning Class Attendance, Participation, and Administrative Drops:

<http://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/class-attendance-participation-and-administrative-drop>

Communicating with Mx. Jazzie Terrell

If you have any questions, concerns, or other general comments about the class, the best way to communicate with me is via email and Calendly appointments for Zoom. I reserve the right to take up to 48 hours to respond M-F and 48 hours over weekends on holidays to respond to your communication, which is during normal business hours and will exclude holidays and weekends.

I will respond within 24 hours, Mondays through Fridays, and will respond at least once over weekends and long holidays. However, I may have to do some grading, look something up, or may just be taking care of their own life requirements. Please do not put off homework because I may not be available to respond to questions at the last minute.

First-Week Attendance Policy

In accordance with the university's policy for high-demand classes, students with excessive absences in the first week of classes will be dropped for non-attendance. If you miss the first two deadlines of the term, you will be considered to have excessive absences.

Instructor-Initiated Drop and Withdrawal Policy

Because attendance is required in this course, excessive absences incurred after the first week can result in your being administratively dropped or withdrawn by your instructor. Please see University Schedule Change–Add/Drop Policies.

Note:

Being dropped from your English class may mean you fall below the minimum number of units, thus violating financial aid/scholarship OR international student status. Before you withdraw (or are withdrawn) from a course, please review the University’s information and policies regarding changes of schedule and consult with your academic advisor. International students should also consult International Student Services before dropping below full-time.

Classroom Behavior

All UArizona students are responsible for upholding the [Student Code of Conduct](#). Students who violate the Student Code of Conduct may be charged by the Dean of Students office. If found responsible, sanctions include but are not limited to academic probation, administrative drops, suspension, or expulsion.

The Student Code of Conduct defines disruptive behavior as “Interfering with or disrupting university or university-sponsored activities, including but not limited to classroom-related activities,



studying, teaching, research, intellectual or creative endeavor, administration, service or the provision of communication, computing or emergency services.”

Actions that disrupt the classroom might include excessive tardiness, the use of cell phones or other electronic devices without the instructor’s permission, engaging in discriminatory activities, or not following the [university guidelines on COVID-19 mitigation](#).

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Plagiarism is considered a violation of the Code of Academic Integrity. The [Council of Writing Program Administrators](#) defines plagiarism in instructional settings as occurring “when a writer deliberately uses someone else’s language, ideas, or other original (not common-knowledge) material without acknowledging its source.” In U.S. academic contexts, this form of academic dishonesty is usually considered a serious offense that should be avoided in order to uphold the common standards of academic integrity in higher education. There are two types of plagiarism you should be aware of:

Intentional plagiarism is a deliberate act of representing another’s work as one’s own.

Unintentional plagiarism occurs by accident when a student is unaware of common academic policies and/or expectations. Unintentional plagiarism is also considered a violation of academic integrity.

Some instructors at UArizona may not distinguish between intentional and unintentional plagiarism.

All students are expected to adhere to the UArizona Code of Academic Integrity.

Inclusivity Statement

The University of Arizona's Writing Program values the diversity of our students and instructors. The range and intersectional nature of the identities and perspectives we inhabit are a source of our strength—including, but not limited to, socioeconomic status, racial identity, ethnic identity, religious affiliation, national identity, language background, gender identity, disability status, and sexual orientation. In this environment, we expect all students and instructors to respect differences and demonstrate diligence in understanding how other peoples' perspectives, behaviors, and worldviews may differ from their own.

We, therefore, seek to cultivate an educational environment of inclusion and mutual respect by welcoming self-definition,



respecting pronouns, honoring elective disclosure of identities, and introducing intersectional content that challenges students to consider a multitude of perspectives, some of which may be unfamiliar or even uncomfortable. Please contact the instructor to discuss any concerns that could affect your ability to participate fully in this course.

For more information about intersectionality, refer to [Intersectionality - LGBTQ+ Resources - Research Guides at Northern Arizona University](#).

For more information about pronouns, refer to the [Guidelines for Use of Pronouns at the University of Arizona](#) or the [Office of Diversity and Inclusion](#).

Accessibility and Accommodations

At the University of Arizona, we strive to make learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience barriers based on disability or pregnancy, please contact the [Disability Resource Center](#) (520-621-3268) to establish reasonable accommodations.

Let Mx. Jazzie Terrell know if there is anything they can do to help you better access the materials in this course, and they will try to do



it if they can. Also, please let them know if you can think of a better way to assess what you know about the course content.

[University Syllabus Policies and Resources](#)